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Section C planning. Analyse questions, 8 marks, about 15 minutes. Plan first, write second.

Ten practice prompts

Each is the same shape as an exam Section C question. Pick one, or your teacher will. Plan it on the sheet below in five minutes, then swap with a partner and check each other against the marks.

MEDIEVAL EUROPE
Analyse the impact of the feudal system on medieval Europe.

MEDIEVAL EUROPE
Analyse the influence of the Catholic Church on medieval European society.

MEDIEVAL EUROPE
Analyse the significance of the Crusades for medieval Europe.

MEDIEVAL EUROPE
Analyse the significant impacts of the Norman Conquest on England.

SHOGUNATE JAPAN
Analyse how the Tokugawa shogunate kept control of Japan for over 250 years.

SHOGUNATE JAPAN
Analyse the significance of sakoku for Japan.

SHOGUNATE JAPAN
Analyse how contact with Western powers contributed to the end of the Tokugawa shogunate.

SHOGUNATE JAPAN
Analyse the impact of the Meiji Restoration on Japan.

BOTH UNITS
Analyse the role of land and loyalty in holding together medieval Europe and shogunate Japan.

BOTH UNITS
Analyse why warrior classes rose to power in both medieval Europe and Japan.

Planning sheet

Unpack the question	Command term **Analyse** means weigh, not list. Topic _____ Limiter (which place, which period, which group) _____
Contention one sentence that answers the question and makes a judgement	
Argument 1 + evidence (name, date, place) + concept	
Argument 2	
Argument 3 (or a counter-view)	
Judgement which mattered most, and why	

Marker's checklist. Contention in the first sentence. Two or three arguments, each with specific dated evidence and a *because* sentence. At least one historical concept named or shown (significance, cause and effect, perspectives, continuity and change). A final sentence that returns to the question with a judgement. Historical terms used correctly.

Concept tags to use: cause and effect · significance · perspectives · continuity and change

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Teacher notes for the ten planning prompts. Possible contention lines and an evidence bank for each. Not for students.

1. Analyse the impact of the feudal system on medieval Europe.

Possible contentions: it shaped power above all, because land was the source of authority; or it shaped daily life most, because the manor controlled where people lived, worked and were judged.

- 1066 land grants, about 180 barons, Domesday 1086
- Oath of fealty, knight service, no paid army
- Manor duties: demesne labour, rents in kind, permission to marry or leave
- Weakening after 1347: labour shortage, 1351 Statute of Labourers, 1381 revolt

Weak answers describe the pyramid. Strong answers choose an area and rank it.

2. Analyse the influence of the Catholic Church on medieval European society.

Choose the type of power (social, political, economic, cultural) and argue it mattered most.

- Baptism, marriage, burial; the year organised by holy days
- Tithe, largest landowner, roughly a quarter of English land
- Excommunication of King John 1209; interdict
- Doom paintings, Latin Mass, monasteries as centres of learning

Ask for one example of each power, then force a ranking.

3. Analyse the significance of the Crusades for medieval Europe.

Significance for Europe, not for the Holy Land: trade, ideas, the Church, or the failure itself.

- Clermont 1095; Jerusalem 1099; Acre 1291
- Venice and Genoa trading posts; spices, sugar, silk
- Contact with Islamic learning: numerals, medicine, Aristotle
- Papal prestige rose then fell; Fourth Crusade sacked Constantinople 1204

The best answers weigh the military failure against the long-term exchange.

4. Analyse the significant impacts of the Norman Conquest on England.

Political (a new ruling class), social (feudalism imposed), cultural (language, castles, churches).

- Hastings 1066; Harrying of the North 1069
- Motte-and-bailey castles in weeks; stone keeps by 1100
- Domesday 1086; English nobles replaced by Normans
- French words in English law and government

Good for teaching the difference between short-term conquest and long-term change.

5. Analyse how the Tokugawa shogunate kept control of Japan for over 250 years.

Control of the daimyo was the key; other policies supported it.

- Sankin kotai: alternate residence, families in Edo, cost of processions
- Buke Shohatto 1615: castles, marriages, alliances
- Four-class system; sword hunts; ban on Christianity 1614
- Sakoku edicts 1633 to 1639; Dejima

The calibration pair on the site (8/8 v 5/8) uses this question; useful for peer marking.

6. Analyse the significance of sakoku for Japan.

Significant in two directions: foundation of the long peace, and the reason it ended so abruptly.

- Edicts 1633 to 1639; Dutch and Chinese at Nagasaki only
- Shimabara 1637 as a trigger
- Edo about a million people by 1700; merchant culture
- 1853: no answer to steamships; unequal treaties

Model paragraph exists on the site (Draft). Students should not have seen it before planning.

7. Analyse how contact with Western powers contributed to the end of the Tokugawa shogunate.

Contributed, not caused: weigh external pressure against internal decline.

- Perry 1853 and 1854; Kanagawa; Harris Treaty 1858
- Samurai debt to merchants; famines of the 1830s; Oshio 1837
- Sonno joi: revere the emperor, expel the barbarians
- Satsuma and Choshu; Boshin War; resignation 1867

Closest of these to the exam's Perry option; use it to teach weighing, and let students see how a trigger differs from a cause.

8. Analyse the impact of the Meiji Restoration on Japan.

Transformation with continuities: political, military, social, economic.

- Domains to prefectures 1871; conscription 1873; swords banned 1876
- Compulsory education; railways; Constitution 1889
- Emperor kept; rule by a small Satsuma-Choshu elite; 1 per cent franchise
- Victory over Russia 1905

Model paragraph exists on the site (Moving Marks pack).

9. Analyse the role of land and loyalty in holding together medieval Europe and shogunate Japan.

Both systems traded land for service; the difference is what loyalty was owed to and how it was enforced.

- Fief and vassal v daimyo domain and stipend
- Chivalry and the Church v bushido and the lord
- King actually ruled v emperor as figurehead above the shogun
- Both weakened when money replaced land as the source of power

Extension prompt. Comparison inside an analyse question is hard; good for strong students.

10. Analyse why warrior classes rose to power in both medieval Europe and Japan.

Weak central authority plus the need for local defence created knights and samurai.

- Viking and Magyar raids; Charlemagne's heirs; castles as local power
- Heian court weakness; provincial warriors; Genpei War 1180 to 1185
- Mounted, armoured, expensive: land to pay for it
- Both classes later lost their military role (gunpowder; conscription 1873)

Extension prompt. Draws on both units' chronology.

> **Why these and not the paper's two.** The exam's Section C options are not here, so nothing a student plans in class is a rehearsal of the exam question. Both exam topics are covered as knowledge across these prompts and on the site; the step from "impact of the feudal system" or "end of the Tokugawa" to the exam's wording is one students should make in the room.

Pairs with Agorian: Paragraph practice → What success looks like → The extended response.

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